

like Battlegrounds Mobile India or Call of Duty: Mobile or even strategy games like Clash of Clans, which just gives a completely different level of satisfaction on a larger canvas. But apart from the performance, I would like to talk about the software experience because that is what makes the Samsung Galaxy Z Fold6 appeal to most people. First and foremost, this is still the only foldable in the world that supports a stylus.

Furthermore, the OneUI Android skin is just more refined than anything else out there. Then comes the multi-tasking and AI features on this Samsung Galaxy Z Fold6. Foldables are beast of multi-taskers when compared to traditional candy bar smartphones. And Samsung's foldable just takes that to a whole new level. There is no limit on the number of pop-up windows you can open for multi-tasking and the gestures and controls to bring everything forward or close everything are just smooth.

Then comes the AI features which are, by far, the most refined and the most fun to play around with. Yes, people will get bored of the "Sketch to image" feature very soon but there is no doubt that playing around it for the first few times is an absolute blast! Then we have the full suit of other features like circle to search or live translation. But one of the best use case of these AI features for the Fold 6 is the interpreter, where you can have the translations on the cover display of the phone, while your conversation comes on the main display. Very convenient for showing or conversing with someone you may have met overseas.

BATTERY AND CHARGING

Now, battery is one area where there is still room for improvement. In our video loop test, the smartphone lasted about 900 minutes, which may sound great since it's almost 15 hours, but comparing it with other foldables, the number looks very small. For reference, the OnePlus Open lasted easily 2 hours longer than the Galaxy Z Fold6, and the Vivo X Fold3 Pro lasted over 200 minutes more than the Samsung Galaxy Z Fold6. It is also important to note here that both the Vivo

X Fold3 Pro and OnePlus Open have bigger batteries. While the Vivo X Fold3 Pro has a 5,700mAh battery and the OnePlus Open has a 4,805mAh battery.

In other scenarios also, the Samsung's battery isn't too impressive. The smartphone drained 5 percent of the battery while streaming a video on YouTube for 30 minutes. While playing Call of Duty: Mobile for just 15 minutes, it lost 6 percent of the battery. And lastly, the smartphone lost 8 percent of its battery while navigating on GPS for 1 hour straight.

Even the charging feels relatively slow with 25W but it's not all that bad in all honesty. The Samsung Galaxy Z Fold6 took almost 75 minutes to charge from 0 to 100, which is just enough for any kind of user. However, if we compare it with the competition, obviously 25W is much slower than the 100W we're getting with the Vivo X Fold3 Pro and the 67W fast charging on the OnePlus Open.

CAMERA

Cameras are another area where I usually like what Samsung has to offer. In the hardware sense, there is no upgrade. The results are also pretty close to what we got last year. The dynamic range on shots from the primary shooter is impressive. In true Samsung fashion, the colours are more towards the vibrant side of things as compared to true-to-life. In low light also, the camera performs well, but I did experience some light bleed and flare around light sources in low lights, which is something that still hasn't been fixed.

These results are consistent in the portrait mode as well. The edge detection is amazing and the background blur can be adjusted according to your taste. Even during the night, the portraits out of the Samsung Galaxy Z Fold6 are very good.

There are also two selfie cameras here. One on the cover display and one under the main display. Now, to save time and effort let me just say that the under display front camera is no good and you're better off using the main selfie camera on the cover display.

So yes, in terms of the camera not much has changed as compared to the Samsung Galaxy Z Fold5 from last year.

From the specifications, to the results, to even the software remains pretty much the same. This year, we can use some AI and draw our own elements in images, but apart from that there is no AI integration in the camera app itself, which is a bit of a bummer since I expected that if not hardware, we will get some sort of a software upgrade with this.

VERDICT

So that was the Samsung Galaxy Z Fold6 for you all. Now, when I took the Fold6 for review I was a bit skeptical about not getting any major upgrades from last year. This also came from the mindset of being a Vivo X Fold3 Pro user who enjoys a proper cover display and an exquisite camera setup. And yes, the Samsung Galaxy Z Fold6 lacks in a lot of areas when we compare it with the competition.

But all that went away when I first held the smartphone in my hands. It just feels more refined in terms of the build quality and design. The hinge feels super reinforced and gives a sense of confidence when folding or unfolding. And apart from that, we are getting the best software experience, along with a host of AI features that just work well. Furthermore, it is the only foldable smartphone that supports a stylus and comes with certified dust protection.

So yes, it may not have the best camera and it may lack in many areas and we may have been getting the same thing over the years with a bit of refinement here and there, but the fact remains. When it comes to refinement and trust, the Samsung Galaxy Z Fold6 remains on top.

—Darab Mansoor Ali

SPECIFICATIONS

Chipset: Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Gen 3 | GPU: Adreno 750 | OS: OneUI 6.1 based on Android 14 | Cover Display: 6.3-inch LTPO AMOLED display | Main Display: 7.6-inch QHD 2X Dynamic AMOLED display | Display Refresh Rate: 120Hz | RAM: Up to 12GB | ROM: Up to 1TB | Cameras (rear): 50MP + 12MP + 10MP | Cameras (front): 10MP + 4MP | Battery: 4400mAh | Charging: 25W

CONTACT

Company: Samsung | Phone: 1800-5-726-7864 | Email: Web form | Website: <https://www.samsung.com/in/>